

Hobbies and sports

Speaking Part 1

Imagine that you are preparing a project with your friend. You have found some interesting material for the presentation and you want to read this text to your friend. You have 1.5 minutes to read the text silently, then be ready to read it out aloud. You will not have more than 1.5 minutes to read it.

Modern hobbies have evolved with the times and have become increasingly diverse. With the advancement of technology, people have access to a wide range of activities and pastimes. One popular modern hobby is photography, which has become more accessible with the rise of smartphones and digital cameras. Social media platforms have also made it easy for people to share their photos and connect with others who share the same interests. Another popular hobby is travelling, with many people using their vacation time to explore new places and cultures. Fitness has also become a popular hobby, with people using technology such as fitness apps and smartwatches to track their progress and set goals. With the increase of e-commerce, online shopping and online marketplaces have become a popular hobby as well. With so many options available, people have the freedom to explore their interests and find new passions. Modern hobbies have also become more inclusive, catering to different ages, abilities, and preferences.

Speaking Part 2. Task 1

What do we call a place where people go bowling? Find the answer in the task.

Study the advertisement.

Bowling Club Pharaoh



You're considering going to the bowling alley and now you'd like to get more information. Ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. opening hours
2. price
3. discounts
4. age restriction

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Look at the following questions asked by a student. What is wrong with them?

Student's answers:

1. What are the opening hours?
2. How much is the price?
3. Have you any discounts?
4. Can I come to your bowling alley if I'm 16?

Speaking Part 2. Task 2

Study the advertisement.

A new ballet school for teenagers



You are considering starting ballet lessons for teenagers and now you'd like to get more information. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. location;
2. tuition fees;
3. special clothes;
4. duration of the course.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Speaking Part 3. Task 1

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions. Give full answers to the questions (2–3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for Task 3

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's Teenagers Round the World Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss hobbies. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: What can one do as a hobby? How much time can one spend on their hobby?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What do you do in your free time? Do you have a lot of free time?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What is your favorite indoor sport? What is your favorite outdoor sport?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Do you prefer watching or playing sports? What sports do you enjoy watching?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What hobbies did you use to have? Is it important to have hobbies? Why/why not?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 1:

1. You have to mention information from the task: What are the opening hours of your bowling alley? When is your bowling alley open?
2. This question does not make sense (the price of the price). How much do I have to pay to play in your bowling alley? How much is a game in your bowling alley?
3. You need an auxiliary verb to ask a question with 'have'. Do you have any discounts? \ Are there any discounts?
4. In this case, your question should be general: Do you have any age restrictions in your bowling alley? Can people of all ages play in your bowling alley?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 1:

1. What is the location of your ballet school? \ Where is your ballet school located?
2. What are the tuition fees for the ballet lessons? \ How much are the tuition fees for the ballet lessons? NOTE the pronunciation of the word ballet - /'bæɪ.leɪ/.
3. Do I need to wear any special clothes during the classes? Is it necessary to wear any special clothes during your ballet lessons?
4. What is the duration of the course? How long does the course last?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 1:

1. There are different types of hobbies. A person can collect things, do some craft, do some sports such as swimming, tennis, football or yoga. I think a person can spend a few hours a week on their hobby.
2. I usually go for a walk with my friends when I have some free time. I don't have much free time, about 1 or 2 hours a day.
3. My favourite indoor sport is yoga. My favourite outdoor sport is swimming.
4. I prefer playing sports. It's so much fun. I play football with my friends. However, I like watching tennis, especially the Olympic games.
5. I used to collect small toys from Kinders. I threw them all away though. I think it's important to have hobbies. It helps to forget about your problems and enjoy the things you like doing.

Speaking Part 3. Task 2

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions.

Give full answers to the questions (2-3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for task 3.

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's *Teenagers Round the World* Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss doing exercise. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: How often do you work out in your free time? Why is it important to work out?

Student: _____

Interviewer: When was the last time you tried something new and exciting? What was it?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Would you rather exercise indoors or go out? What influences your choice?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What do people do to keep fit and healthy nowadays?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What are the advantages of getting regular exercise? Are there any disadvantages?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

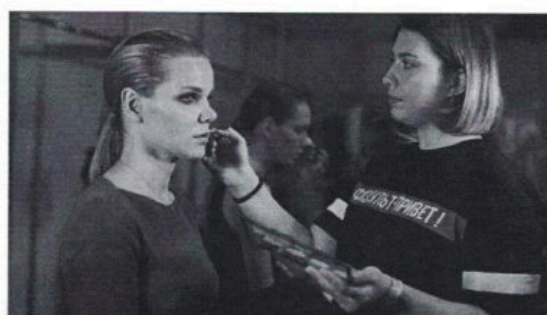
Speaking Part 4. Task. 1

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Creative hobbies".

You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1-2) of the two kinds of hobbies;
- mention the disadvantages (1-2) of the two kinds of hobbies;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which hobby presented in the pictures you'd prefer to take up and why;

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12-15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 2:

1. When I have some free time, I sometimes work out. It happens two or three times a week. I think it's important to work out because it helps your body stay in shape and it makes you feel good.
2. The last time I tried something new and exciting was a week ago. I tried kart racing. It was really breathtaking. I enjoyed it a lot.
3. I'd rather go out. I like spending time with my friends. Whenever there is a choice of doing something alone or with someone else, I choose to spend time in company.
4. A lot of people do yoga. It's got to be very popular in Russia. I know that many people also go to the gym. It's also good to get a personal trainer.
5. If you do exercise regularly, you feel good. You also get ill less often. I don't think there are any disadvantages of doing sports. A person just needs to follow the rules and consult specialists to do sport in the right way. This could help to avoid injuries.

Sample answer for Speaking Part 4. Task 1:

Hi, Sam, it's Masha! Listen, I've found some illustrations for our project "Creative hobbies" and I'd like to tell you about them.

I think both photos are quite suitable for our project as we can see enthusiastic people who are keen on their hobbies. In one picture there's a woman taking a photo somewhere outdoors, perhaps in the park. In the other picture, a woman seems to be involved in putting on makeup. Perhaps, there's a make-up artist and a model in a dressing room. Although both pictures are related to hobbies, they demonstrate different emotions expressed by the people in them. I can see that the first woman is quite relaxed and is enjoying the process while the second woman is highly concentrated on working with another person.

There are some advantages of doing both of these hobbies. Photographers can work just a few hours a day. Helping women with their make-up is a process of creating beauty. Such a hobby gives positive emotions to people who do it. In addition, both of these hobbies can help people earn money.

Unfortunately, there are also some disadvantages of the two kinds of hobbies. I suppose the most obvious disadvantage of taking photos is that professional cameras are quite costly nowadays, while the most striking disadvantage of being a make-up artist is working with people who can make some unpleasant comments of the result of your work.

Personally, I would prefer to take up photography as my hobby because I am a very creative person who can feel the wonder of the world around me.

I hope you won't mind taking these pictures for our project. Call me back.

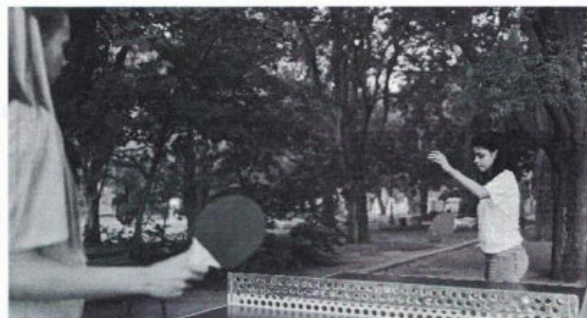
Speaking Part 4. Task 2

Fill in the gaps in the following sample answer for the task:

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Sports for teens". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1-2) of the two kinds of sports for teens;
- mention the disadvantages (1-2) of the two kinds of sports for teens;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which type of sports presented in the pictures you'd prefer and why;

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12-15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



_____ Mary, it's Sasha. I've found 2 pictures for our project "Sports for teens". I'd like to _____ them with you.

I think we should _____ these illustrations because they both show teenagers _____ sports. _____ the first photo I can see some boys. Perhaps they are playing _____ because they are wearing orange _____. Maybe one of the _____ has just _____ a goal because the other boys are hugging him. _____ the second photo, there are two girls _____ table tennis. I think they are playing in the park. The difference _____ the pictures is in the types of sports they are playing: a _____ sport and a sport for two people.

Both of the types of sports for teens _____ their pluses. Playing _____ is interesting and develops _____ a lot. When teenagers play table tennis, it develops _____ hand-eye coordination. In _____, it's always beneficial to spend time _____ playing both of the types of sports.

Unfortunately, I believe _____ two sports also have some drawbacks. A teenager can get a serious _____ when playing football. It's a very aggressive game sometimes. As for table tennis, it's sometimes not possible to play it _____ because of the _____.

I _____ to play table tennis. My uncle has a ping-pong table which I can use to play this game. He can teach me how to play _____.

That's all. What do you think about the pictures? _____ me back. Bye.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 4. Task 2:

Hi Mary, it's Sasha. I've found 2 pictures for our project "Sports for teens". I'd like to discuss them with you.

I think we should take these illustrations because they both show teenagers doing playing sports. In the first photo I can see some boys. Perhaps they are playing football because they are wearing orange T-shirts. Maybe one of the boys has just scored a goal because the other boys are hugging him. In the second photo, there are two girls playing table tennis. I think they are in the park. The difference between the pictures is in the types of sports they play: a team sport and a sport for two people.

Both of the types of sports for teens have their pluses. Playing football is interesting and develops muscles a lot. When teenagers play table tennis, it develops their hand-eye coordination. In addition, it's always beneficial to spend time outdoors playing both of the types of sports.

Unfortunately, I believe these two sports also have some drawbacks. A teenager can get a serious injury when playing football. It's a very aggressive game sometimes. As for table tennis, it's sometimes not possible to play it outdoors because of the wind.

I'd prefer would prefer to play table tennis. My uncle has a ping-pong table which I can use to play this game. He can teach me how to play well.

That's all. What do you think about the pictures? Call me back. Bye.

Writing an email. Asking questions. Task 1

Read the following sentences from emails. Make up questions that you could ask.

I've finally chosen pictures for the school photography contest.

Pictures:

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

The school photography contest:

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

I got a new camera for my birthday last week!

Her new camera:

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

Her birthday:

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

You should always make sure you write appropriate questions for the task. This is one of the common mistakes students make. They write questions to something that is written in the email and forget to look at the task. The actual task is given after the words "ask 3 questions about..." Students also cannot ask a question to something that is stated in the email. For example, for this task the question 'What kind of contest is it?' is inappropriate as it is already stated that it is a school photography contest.

Writing an email. Task 2

You have received an email message from your English-speaking pen-friend Jerry:

From: Jerry@mail.uk
To: Russian_friend@ege.ru
Subject: Favourite sport
<i>... You know, I'm fond of football and I visited a few matches during 2018 World Cup in Russia. What kind of international event would you like to visit and why? What sports are you fond of and do you play them yourself? What's your PE class at school like?</i>
<i>BTW, I got a wonderful book as a birthday present...</i>

Write an email to Jerry.

In your message:

- answer his questions;
- ask **3 questions** about his birthday present.

Write **100–140 words**.

Remember the rules of email writing.

Writing Task 38. Problem and solution

Read the following problem and solution, written by a student. What do you think of it? Will it be approved?

Outline a problem that can arise with DIY hobbies and suggest a way of solving it.

While I was working on my project, I noticed a number of problems that are related to teen's hobbies. The pie chart illustrates that an overwhelming majority of the respondents choose paper modeling as a way to spend their spare time. Obviously, this number of teens uses a great amount of paper. It can lead to ecological problems such as deforestation which may cause a decrease in biodiversity. What can be done to combat this problem is to make ecological events aimed to explain teens how to reduce, reuse and recycle not only paper but also other materials.

Suggested answers for questions. Writing an email. Task 1:

Pictures:

1. How many pictures have you chosen?
2. What is there in the pictures?
3. Did you take those pictures or were they taken by somebody else?

The school photography contest:

How many participants will there be?

When will it start?

What's the prize for the winner?

Her new camera:

1. What brand is it?
2. Is it digital?
3. What colour is it?

Her birthday:

1. Did you celebrate it with your parents or friends?
 2. What other presents did you get for your birthday?
 3. Did many people call to wish you something nice on your birthday?
- The question 'When was your birthday?' is inappropriate.

Sample answer for writing an email. Task 2:

Dear Jerry,

Thanks for your email. It's always great to hear from you.

In your email you asked me some questions about sport. I would like to visit Wimbledon because I love tennis and I play tennis myself twice a week with my friends. I also love volleyball but I only play it once or twice a month. My PE classes are quite exciting. We compete against each other all the time and have lots of fun.

By the way, it's great that you got a wonderful book as a present. What's the name of the book? How many pages are there? Is it a paperback or in hardcover?

Hope to hear from you soon!

All the best,

Alla

119 words

Answers for Writing Task 38. Problem and solution:

Expert's comment

Teen – informal + a grammar mistake – refers to a plural noun and should be written as «teens' hobbies» - «teenagers' hobbies» would be the correct form.

The problem stated by the student is absurd. Using paper for DIY hobbies cannot lead to such disastrous consequences. So, the problem cannot be approved. As for the solution, it has nothing to do with DIY hobbies, so it cannot be approved either.

Writing Task 38. Introduction

We are going to learn how to write introductions for EGE essays (based on tables and pie charts), which meet all the criteria.

First, read the following Introductions written by an expert and figure out what the requirements are.

What teenagers in Zetland use social networks for

Social networks have become an integral part of almost everyone's life. They are one of the means of communication, but they can also be used in many other ways. I am currently doing a project on what teenagers in Zetland use social networks for, and I have found some results of a relevant survey which are important to consider.

Why young people in Zetland do extreme sports

There is an assumption that more and more people take up extreme sports these days. I am currently working on a project on why young people in Zetland do extreme sports. I have found some results of a survey in the form of a table which are important to consider.

Leisure activities most popular among senior citizens in Zetland

When a person is old, they usually have much free time. As part of my project about the most popular leisure activities among senior citizens in Zetland I found some results of opinion polls presented in a pie chart and now I am going to analyse them.

Criteria of a EGE Introduction of an essay:

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____
- 4) _____
- 5) _____
- 6) _____
- 7) _____

Write your introduction to the following task:

The DIY hobbies most popular among teenagers in Zetland. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the pie chart below).

Criteria of a EGE Introduction of an essay:

1. write an introductory sentence (this is not obligatory, but advisable).
2. mention the name of the project (it is advisable not to paraphrase it as this is not mentioned in the criteria and paraphrasing could lead to a distortion of an original idea, thus a student may lose points).
3. mention the word 'project' or say that you are doing it in any turn of words
4. mention the country - Zetland
5. mention the table\pie chart that you have found (if the words 'table' or 'pie chart' are not mentioned in the introduction, they should be mentioned in the following paragraph).
6. mention what kind of information you have found - some results of a survey.
7. formal register – no contractions can be used (isn't, couldn't, shouldn't...), avoid informal words or slang (words marked so by reliable English-English dictionaries), no questions (interrogative sentences).

Sample answer:

In modern world, it is critical for young people to have a hobby to spend their leisure time. I am working on a project which is aimed at establishing what DIY hobbies have the highest popularity among teenagers in Zetland. I have found a pie chart with some results of a relevant survey.

Writing Task 38. Task 2

Imagine that you are doing a project on **extreme sports in Zetland**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the table below).

Comment on the survey data and give your opinion on the subject of the project.

The survey question: What extreme sports do you do?	
Extreme sports	Number of respondents (%)
Snowboarding	48
Mountain climbing	26
Mountain biking	13
Rollerblading	8
Skateboarding	5

Write **200-250 words**.

Use the following plan:

- make an opening statement on the subject of the project;
- select and report 2-3 facts;
- make 1-2 comparisons where relevant and give your comments;
- outline a problem that one can face doing extreme sports and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on choosing a particular sport to get healthier.

Put the following sentences in the correct order:

1. Interestingly, twice as many of the people climb mountains (26%) as those who do mountain biking (13%).
2. I am currently doing a project on extreme sports in Zetland.
3. To tackle the problem, one should always take lessons with a professional trainer to learn how to do extreme sports in a safe way.
4. As can be seen in the table, almost half of the respondents go snowboarding (48%).
5. Some people have medical conditions and they should consider them when choosing how to exercise.
6. Extreme sports are getting more and more popular around the globe.
7. Everyone should choose an appropriate sport if they want to get healthier.
8. Approximately one tenth of the people do rollerblading (8%).
9. One can get an injury and can even become severely disabled because of a serious accident.
10. I have found some results of a relevant survey in the form of table which are important to consider.
11. Unfortunately, there is an obvious problem that can occur if people do extreme sports.
12. In conclusion, I believe it is of utmost importance to consult a doctor before taking up new sports.
13. It seems logical to me as it is riskier to ride a bike in such terrain than to climb.
14. Only 5% of those surveyed do skateboarding in Zetland as an extreme sport.

Answers for writing Task 38. Task 2

Answers: 6 2 10 4 8 14 1 13 11 9 3 12 7 5

Extreme sports are getting more and more popular around the globe. I am currently doing a project on extreme sports in Zetland. I have found some results of a relevant survey in the form of a table which are important to consider. As can be seen in the table, almost half of the respondents go snowboarding (48%). Approximately one tenth of the people do rollerblading (8%). Only 5% of those surveyed practise skateboarding as an extreme sport in Zetland. Interestingly, twice as many of the people participate in mountain climbing (26%) compared to those who do mountain biking (13%). It seems logical to me as it is riskier to ride a bike in such terrain than to climb. Unfortunately, there is an obvious problem that can occur if people do extreme sports. One can get an injury and can even become severely disabled because of a serious accident. To tackle the problem, one should always take lessons with a professional trainer to learn how to do extreme sports in a safe way. In conclusion, I believe it is of utmost importance to consult a doctor before taking up new sports. Everyone should choose an appropriate sport if they want to get healthier. Some people have medical conditions, and they should take them into consideration when choosing how to exercise.

213words

Real-life Task 38

Quick questionnaire

Follow the QR-code link or the link below. Answer the question about how you prefer to spend your free time and see the results of other students.

Take a picture of the results and write your data description. Compare two figures and give a comment. Since it's a real-life opinion poll, the results change all the time, so you can do the task again in a while. Keep in mind that the respondents are Russian teenagers.

Address the following:

- outline a problem that can arise with some of the ways of spending free time and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on the best way of spending free time for you.

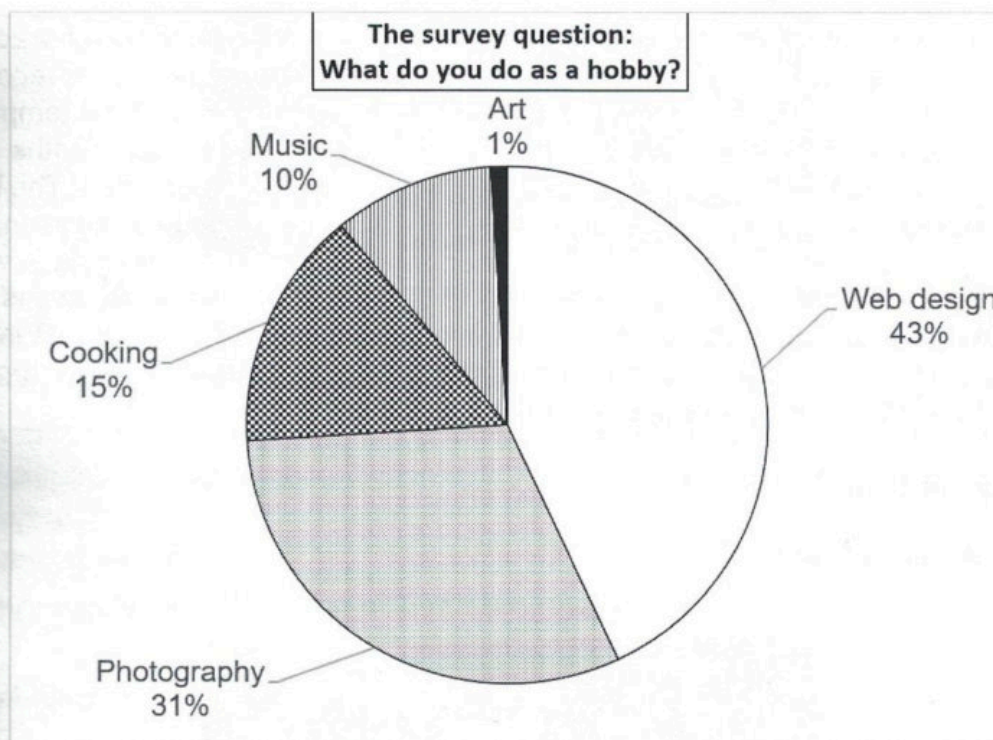


<https://forms.gle/rmTBxRgCHPjswTSL9>

Writing Task 38. Task 2 (Sample answer on page 173)

Imagine that you are doing a project on **what hobbies are popular among teenagers in Zetland**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the pie chart below).

Comment on the survey data and give your opinion on the subject of the project.



Write 200-250 words.

Use the following plan:

- make an opening statement on the subject of the project;
- select and report 2-3 facts;
- make 1-2 comparisons where relevant and give your comments;
- outline a problem that one can face doing hobbies and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on choosing a hobby for your soul.